Etruscan Foundation and the Gladys Krieble Delmas Foundation for his work on Etruscan Texts Project (etp.classics.umass.edu), an online database of inscriptions with historical and linguistic commentary.

Epigraphical quiz! This was the first inscription published in Hesperia. The article is by Oscar Broneer, "Eros and Aphrodite on the North Slope of the Acropolis," *Hesperia* 1 (1931) 31-55. The inscription is on p. 44.

Epigraphical Notes

(This is the second article in what I hope will become a regular part of the newsletter. Members are invited to submit brief notes on emendations, interpretation, epigraphical pedagogy, or technical aspects of epigraphy.)

CIL I² 607 L.I.XXVI

The left face of the well-known Roman votive inscription CIL I² 607,[1] traditionally dated to 217 BC[2] and carved on a tufa statue base,[3] contains the enigmatic notation "L.I.XXVI".[4] The full text of the inscription (the final two letters of which are continued onto the right face) reads as follows:

L.I.XXVI | | HERCOLEI
SACROM
M.MINUCI.C.F
DICTATOR[.]VOV¢ | | IT[5]

What is the meaning of "L.I.XXVI"? Three types of interpretation have been proposed, none of them entirely satisfactory.

Ritschl's contention that this refers to the first and twenty-sixth legions (L = *legiones*), argued at some length and with full cognizance of various difficulties this poses (*Suppl.* pp. ix-xi), is scarcely credible, and receives no mention even in CIL I² fasc. 1 (p. 499). Among other problems beyond those discussed by Ritschl, L = *legio* in Republican inscriptions is restricted to entirely different contexts, as in several instances in the Lex Repetundarum (CIL I² 583.2, 16, 22), its appearance after a list of veterans (CIL I² 1757), and on *glandes* (e.g. CIL I² 870-872). Nor would it be easy to understand why such a notation was engraved (with smaller lettering) on the left face, and not placed somewhere on the front face, where considerable space was available beneath the main text.

According to Henzen (CIL p. 499, citing his earlier discussion), the numbers indicate the position designated for the "altar" (sic, cf. n. 3), with "L" = *locus* (or another of its case forms). He considered this view to be

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[1] Degrassi, *ILLRP* 118 and *Imagines* 59 (front face only); Gordon, *Introduction* 6 (with photograph [pl. 5] of front face only); Wachter, *Altlat. Inschr.* §§115, 118a; Warmington, *Remains* p. 76; Ritschl *Suppl.* IA = *Opusc.* 4 tab. XVA; further references at CIL I² (fasc. 4) p. 918.

[2] But see CIL p. 918 (with references) for discussion of the dating problem; a late-3rd century date, in any case, is assured.

[3] Not, as in CIL and elsewhere, an "altar"; see Gordon.

[4] According to Gordon's measurements, the letters and numerals on the left face (7.5 cm.) are approximately one cm. shorter than the shortest lettering of the remainder of the text (which varies between ca. 8.5 and 9.5 c.m.).

[5] On the "in latere" notation of VOV¢ || IT (relatively rare at Rome, but not uncommon elsewhere during this period), see my remarks in *Studies* 308 (more generally 303ff.).

confirmed by the series of "Massae marmoris" catalogued by Dessau (*ILS* 8713-8725), some of which attest similar notations.[6] Warmington (*Remains*, p. 76 n. 2) concurred with this argument, while parenthetically noting one of its signal weaknesses, namely that the marble texts (all of which date from a much later period, generally 2nd c. AD) never contain notations with "I" following "L" (nor, it can be added, do they contain compound numerical notations, if the "I" here is taken to be the number one, as in Ritschl's conception); hence Warmington's tentative suggestion *l(apis) i(nscriptus)* for L.I., without further discussion of what this might mean together with the numeral.

More recently, Degrassi (*ILLRP* 118, n. 2 ad loc.) suggests, perhaps most plausibly, that the entire sequence is some sort of stonecutter's notation, an approach followed by Gordon. Yet the interpretation of this text remains uncertain; what is missing, in particular, are plausible parallels. It seems worthwhile, then, not only to call attention to this problem once again, but also to inject two possible parallels into the discussion, in hopes that this may eventually lead to a satisfactory solution.

In a somewhat similar instance,[7] I interpreted the equally enigmatic notation "XLVI" as a stonecutter's indication of the length of the text, as the inscription in question contained exactly 46 letters. The same interpretation could be applied in this case, if one is willing to accept that XXVI is an error for XX<X>VI: the text of CIL I² 607 (not including the left-face *explanandum* under discussion) contains 36 letters. If this interpretation is correct, "L.I." might better be conceived as an indication of what was to be engraved (rather than what had already been carved); thus perhaps *lapis inscribendus*, with the entire sequence standing for a notation (or instruction?) along the lines of *l(apis) i(nscribendus)*[8] *XX<X>VI [litteris]*. Despite, however, the attractiveness of a simple haplographic omission, the assumption of error is somewhat problematic for a text that (apart from the *in latere* notation of VOVC | | IT) is rather carefully engraved, including the indentation in the second line.[9]

There is a further intriguing parallel that deserves to be adduced, from a set of wall inscriptions from Paestum, dating from the early 3rd c. BC.[10] Here, a series of limestone blocks, in a wall built around 400 (but with later repairs), contain the notation LAPIS IMFOSOS (= nom. sg. *lapis infossus*).[11] The reference, apparently, is to stone blocks that were inserted ("dug in"), during later repairs, into the existing structure. The rationale for these notations remains obscure.[12] Nor, to be sure, do these texts contain numeration, although the notation in question is repeated on a number of stones. Still, it

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[6] Generally *loco* followed by number (8713, 8721a/b/c, 8722a/b/c), but also *locus n. II* (8716a), and the abbreviation *loc.* followed by number (e.g. 8720).

[7] *AE* (1982) 80 (*Not. scav.* 1920, 220 no. 2), line 7 (the last line of the text); see *Studies* 308 n. 19.

[8] Or rather, for this period, *i(nscribundus)*.

[9] I have discussed this pattern in *Studies* 106f.

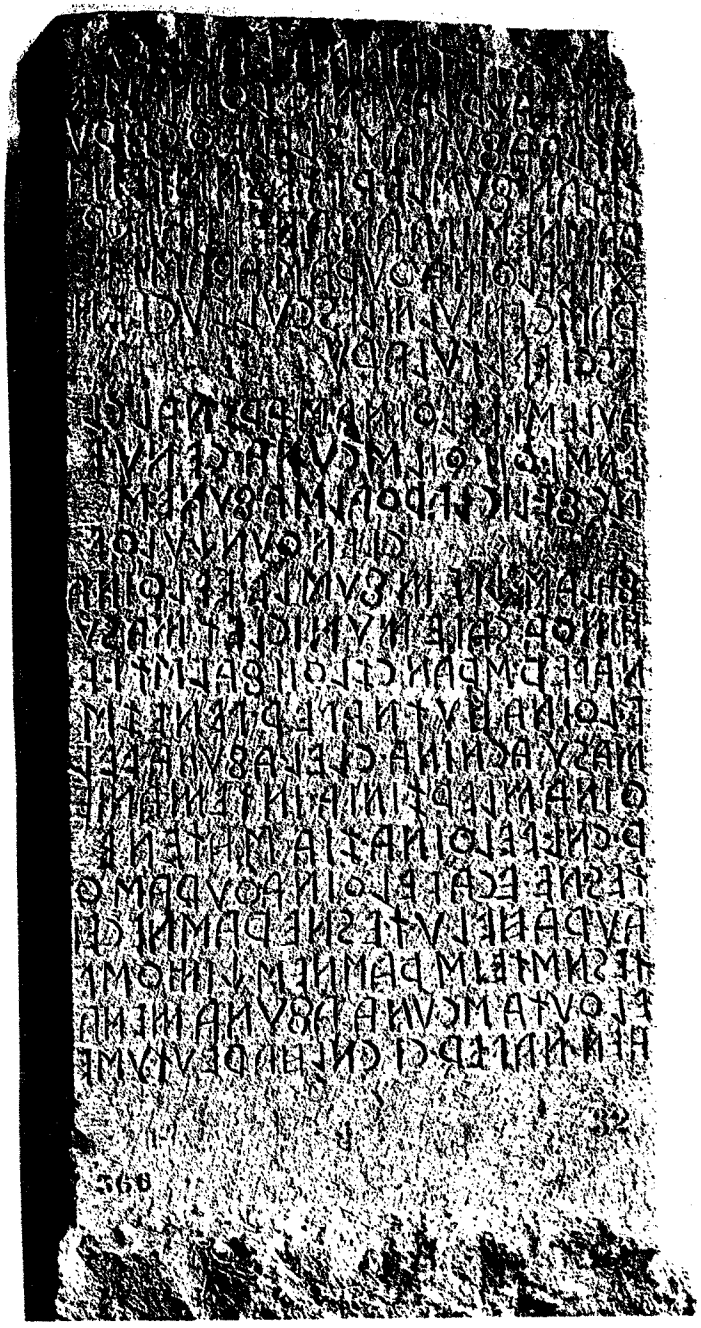
[10] CIL I² 2875a-e; Wachter, *Altlat. Inschr.* §198c; Mello-Voza, *ILP* 135-8 (with photographs, tab. 22).

[11] Thus 2875a/b, cf.]IMFOSOS 2875c,]IMFOSO[2875d,]PIS IMFOSOS 2875e.

[12] Cf. Degrassi (CIL I² p. 883, ad loc.): "Sed cur lapides postea immissi inscriptionibus suis designari debuerint, me fugit."

seems worth considering whether the marking "L.I." (followed by a number) on a tufa block from later in the same century may recover the same reference — whatever it may mean exactly — to a *"l(apis) i(nfossus)"* (perhaps the 26th such block in a series or inventory of a particular *officina*). One could, finally, attempt to combine the above two hypotheses, whereby the indication *"l(apis) i(nfossus)"* is followed by a stonecutter's marking of the number of letters to be engraved on it.

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